Cybersecurity Manual

KeePassXC

Template Version: v0.39 (26 October 2026) · Document version 0.1 · 2026-11-08

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1 Introduction

This document provides information & instructions to the user as required by the EU Cyber Resilience Act (CRA, EU regulation (2024/2847)). Its contents are in line with the CRA Annex II requirements. Note: All chapters marked [optional] are not legally required by the CRA.

The intention of this document is to provide the user with all necessary information pertaining to the cybersecurity of the product. Reading and understanding this document is required to ensure the secure setup, use, and decommissioning of the product.

The focus of this document is on explaining how to securely use the product, not on explaining how to use the product in general. It is a cybersecurity manual and does not replace user manuals.

1.1 Quick reference

Product properties and context	2.1 Product (P): KeePassXC · KeePassXC 2.8.0 (released 21 October 2026) 2.2 Security Properties (SP): SP01 Database encryption, SP02 Key derivation against guessing, SP03 Additional unlock factors, SP04 Protected attributes, SP05 No network access by default, SP06 Signed releases
How to use the product securely	3.2 Secure commissioning and setup 3.3 Secure use: Conditions of Use (CU) and Circumstances leading to Risk (CR) per product Function (FC): FC01 Store and retrieve credentials, FC02 Fill credentials in the browser, FC03 Auto-Type into other applications, FC04 Unlock the database, FC05 Share and sync databases
Contact and links	4.1 Manufacturer information: KeePassXC Team (volunteer project); Windows binaries published by DroidMonkey Apps, LLC. CRA role allocation is for the working group. · team@keepassxc.org · keepassxc.org

1.2 Document information

Version	0.1
Date	2026-11-08
Author	Cairn Viktor for the Value Chain Risk Institute (illustrative example, not the manufacturer's manual)

1.3 Definitions

For more information on each of these concepts, please refer to the Cyber Manual GUIDANCE.

ID	Concept	Description
P	Product	The product under consideration.
PC	Product component	The components the product consists of.
PI	Physical interfaces	Physical interfaces implemented in the product.
PP	Product protocol / service	Logical interfaces (protocols and services) implemented in the product.
C	Context	Reflects the manufacturer's assumptions on the operational environment of the product. Contains all elements (technical components, persons, zones) that do not belong to the product but are needed to describe the product functions.
CC	Context component	The components (systems, networks) the context consists of.
CP	Context persons	Persons that interact with the product.
CZ	Context zones	Zones that categorize context components or persons for example based on physical location, organizational structure, or trust boundaries.
FC	Function	Behavior or capability that a product must perform to satisfy stakeholder needs. The core and ancillary functionality of the product.
SP	Security Property	Security characteristics implemented in the product. The manufacturer is responsible for implementing the Security Properties.
CU	Conditions of Use	Security characteristics implemented in the product context. The user is responsible for meeting the conditions of use to ensure secure use of the product.
IPRFU	Intended purpose and reasonably foreseeable use	The combination of the context, product functions, and the conditions of use: A product is used according to its intended purpose and reasonably foreseeable use when it is used - In the defined context - for the defined functions - adhering to the defined conditions of use.
CR	Circumstances leading to significant cybersecurity risk	Violation of a condition of use, reasonably foreseeable misuse or other circumstances the user can influence that may lead to unwanted damage scenarios.

1.4 References [optional]

- keepassxc.org/download
- keepassxc.org/verifying-signatures
- keepassxc.org/audits
- keepassxc.org/docs (FAQ) and keepassxc.org/docs/KeePassXC_UserGuide
- github.com/keepassxreboot/keepassxc/blob/develop/SECURITY.md

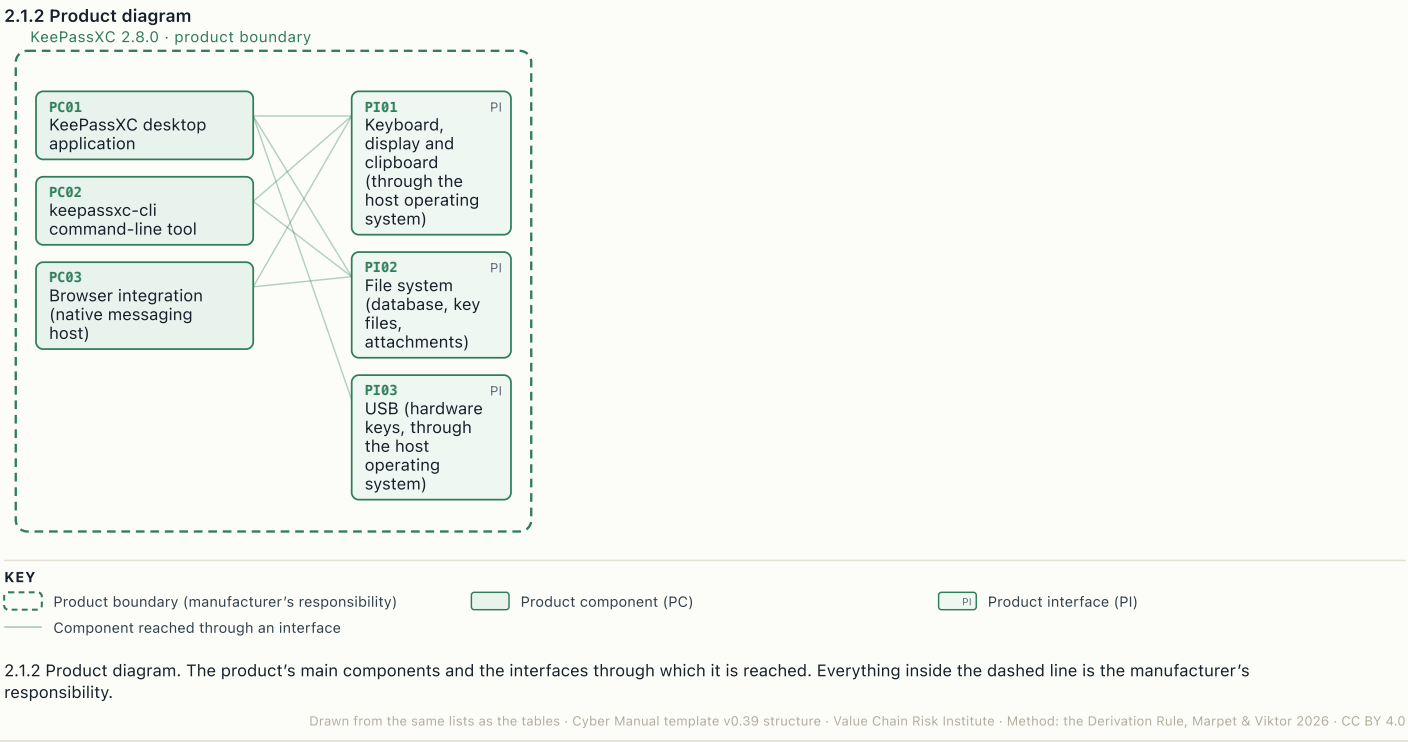
2 Product properties and context

2.1 Product (P)

2.1.1 Product identification

Product name	KeePassXC
Product type / model / version	KeePassXC 2.8.0 (released 21 October 2026)
Product identification [optional]	NOT FOUND in the public documentation read on 8 November 2026.
Additional information [optional]	Illustrative example for the Cyber Manual Movement, built by the Value Chain Risk Institute with the CRA Manual Builder from public documentation read on 8 November 2026. It is NOT the manufacturer's manual and makes no claim about CRA conformity. Gaps are marked NOT FOUND rather than filled in. Desktop password manager for Windows, macOS and Linux, licensed GPL v3. Password managers are listed in CRA Annex III, Class I. KeePassXC is developed by a volunteer team, and its Windows installer names DroidMonkey Apps, LLC as publisher. Whether anyone is a CRA manufacturer here, or the non-commercial and open-source steward provisions apply, is left to the working group.

2.1.2 Product diagram [optional]



2.1.2 Product diagram. The product's main components and the interfaces through which it is reached. Everything inside the dashed line is the manufacturer's responsibility.

Drawn from the same lists as the tables · Cyber Manual template v0.39 structure · Value Chain Risk Institute · Method: the Derivation Rule, Marpet & Viktor 2026 · CC BY 4.0

2.1.3 Product components (PC) list [optional]

ID	Title & Description
PC01	KeePassXC desktop application
PC02	keepassxc-cli command-line tool
PC03	Browser integration (native messaging host)

2.1.4 Product interfaces [optional]

PHYSICAL INTERFACES

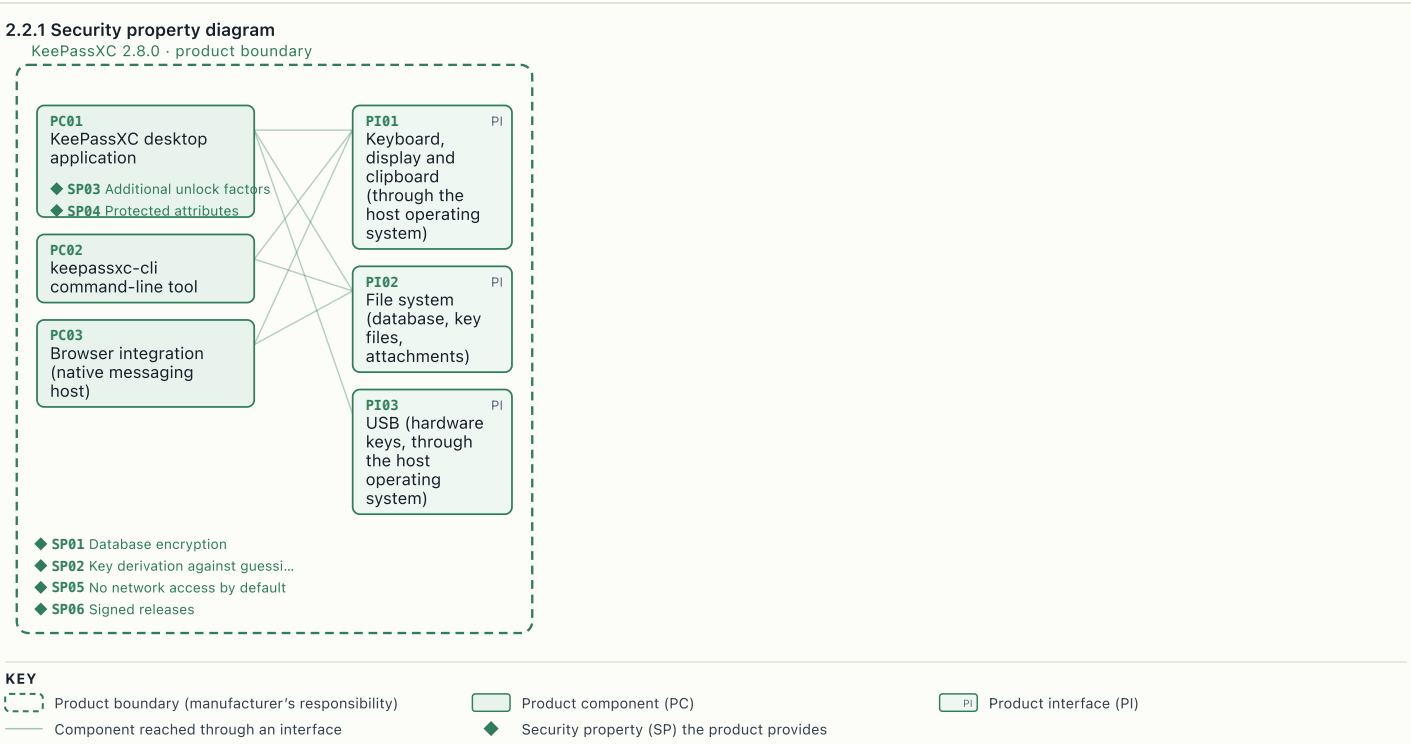
ID	Title / Description
PI01	Keyboard, display and clipboard (through the host operating system)
PI02	File system (database, key files, attachments)
PI03	USB (hardware keys, through the host operating system)

PROTOCOLS AND SERVICES

ID	Protocol / Service / URL	Physical interface	Port	Function	Enabled by default
PP01	Native messaging with the KeePassXC-Browser extension (local)	PI01 Keyboard, display and clipboard	/	FC02 Fill credentials in the browser	no (off until enabled)
PP02	Synthetic keystrokes (Auto-Type)	PI01 Keyboard, display and clipboard	/	FC03 Auto-Type into other applications	on user action
PP03	Secret Service over D-Bus (Linux)	/	/	FC01 Store and retrieve credentials	no (off until enabled)
PP04	SSH agent (OpenSSH agent, Pageant)	/	/	FC01 Store and retrieve credentials	no (setup required)
PP05	HTTPS favicon download	/	443	FC01 Store and retrieve credentials	opt-in
PP06	Hardware key challenge-response (YubiKey, OnlyKey)	PI03 USB	/	FC01 Store and retrieve credentials; FC04 Unlock the database	if configured

2.2 Security Properties (SP)

2.2.1 Security property diagram [optional]



2.2.1 Security property diagram. Which security properties the product provides, and on which component or interface each one sits.

Drawn from the same lists as the tables · Cyber Manual template v0.39 structure · Value Chain Risk Institute · Method: the Derivation Rule, Marpet & Viktor 2026 · CC BY 4.0

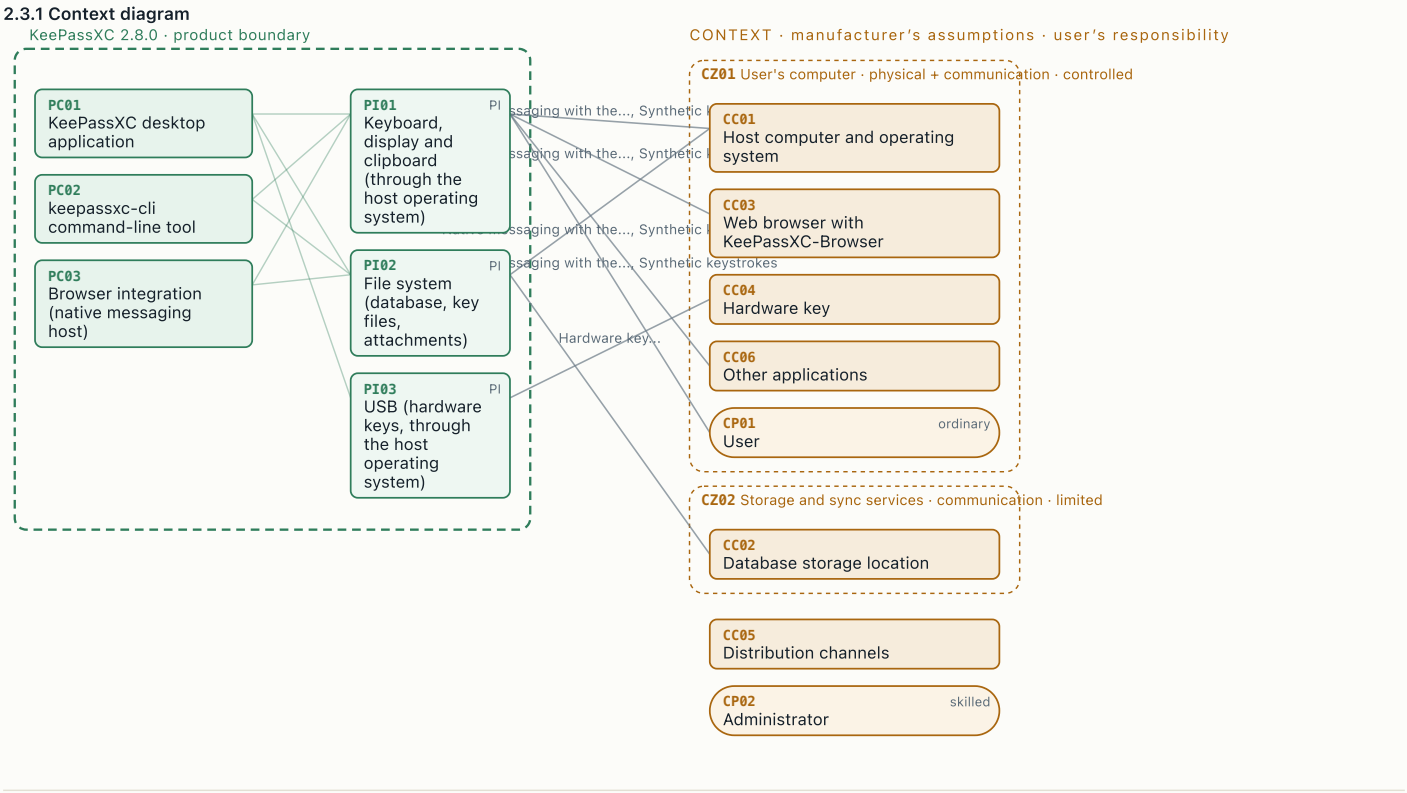
2.2.2 Security property list

ID	Affected component(s)	Title & Description
SP01	Product: KeePassXC	**Database encryption** `2e` `2f` The database is encrypted with AES-256 or Twofish and is encrypted at all times on disk.
SP02	Product: KeePassXC	**Key derivation against guessing** `2d` `2e` With KDBX 4, the Argon2 key derivation function (recommended) transforms the composite master key, making dictionary attacks slower.
SP03	Product: KeePassXC	**Additional unlock factors** `2d` A key file and hardware-key challenge-response (YubiKey, OnlyKey) can be added to the master password.
SP04	Product: KeePassXC	**Protected attributes** `2e` Attributes marked Protect are hidden by default and shown only on Reveal.
SP05	Product: KeePassXC	**No network access by default** `2j` Network access is opt-in (favicon downloads); a build without networking code is possible.

SP06	Product: KeePassXC	**Signed releases** `2c` `2f` Every package ships with a PGP signature and a SHA-256 digest. The Windows MSI carries an Authenticode signature (DroidMonkey Apps, LLC); macOS builds are signed with the project's Apple Developer ID and checked at launch.

2.3 Context (C)

2.3.1 Context diagram [optional]



2.3.1 Context diagram. What the product relies on outside its boundary, who works with it, and in which zones. Everything outside the dashed line is an assumption the user is responsible for making true.

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2.3.2 Context component (CC) list

ID	Title & Description
CC01	**Host computer and operating system** The Windows, macOS or Linux computer KeePassXC runs on.
CC02	**Database storage location** Local disk, a synced folder or a remote location holding the database file.
CC03	**Web browser with KeePassXC-Browser** A browser with the extension installed from its official store.

CC04	**Hardware key** A YubiKey or OnlyKey configured for challenge-response.
CC05	**Distribution channels** keepassxc.org, Microsoft Store, winget, Chocolatey, Homebrew, Flathub, Snap and distribution packages.
CC06	**Other applications** Programs that receive Auto-Type keystrokes or Secret Service and SSH agent requests.

2.3.3 Context person (CP) list [optional]

ID	Title & Description	Skill (ordinary, instructed, skilled)
CP01	**User** The person who keeps passwords in the database.	ordinary
CP02	**Administrator** A person enforcing settings through Windows Group Policy.	skilled

2.3.4 Context zone (CZ) list [optional]

ID	Title & Description	Type (physical, communication)	Access (public, limited, controlled)
CZ01	**User's computer** The host computer and its user account	physical + communication	controlled
CZ02	**Storage and sync services** Places outside the computer where the database is stored or synced	communication	limited

3 How to use the product securely

This chapter describes the secure use of the product across its lifecycle.

3.1 Intended Purpose and reasonably foreseeable use (IPRFU)

Generally, secure use of the product means using it in line with its intended purpose and reasonably foreseeable use (IPRFU).

The intended purpose and reasonably foreseeable use of the product are defined as product use

- in the context (C) defined in chapter 2.3,
- for the functions (FC) defined in chapters 3.3 and 3.4,
- while adhering to the conditions of use (CU) defined in chapters 3.3 and 3.4.

3.2 Secure commissioning and setup

Secure default configurations are listed in chapter 2.2 Security Properties (SP). The information which protocols are enabled or disabled by default is provided in the interfaces list in chapter 2.1 Product (P).

Additional remarks for secure commissioning and setup:

- Download from keepassxc.org or an official channel and verify it (chapter 3.4).
- Create a database in KDBX 4 format with Argon2.
- Set a strong master password; optionally add a key file or hardware key.
- Decide whether Quick Unlock should stay enabled.
- Set up a backup of the database.

3.3 Secure use: Conditions of Use (CU) and Circumstances leading to Risk (CR) per product Function (FC)

3.3.1 Function FC01 Store and retrieve credentials

FUNCTION (FC)

ID	FC01
Title	Store and retrieve credentials
Description	Create, edit, search and copy entries in an encrypted KDBX database.
Reasonably foreseeable use [optional]	Keeping the only copy of the database on one device.
Core / ancillary functionality	core functionality

SECURE USE DIAGRAM [OPTIONAL]

CONDITIONS OF USE (CU)

ID	Affects (component CC / person CP / zone CZ)	Title & Description
CU01	CP01 User	**Strong master password** 2d Use a strong master password; add a key file or hardware key for more protection.
CU02	CC02 Database storage location	**Keep backups** 2h Back up the database, key files and hardware-key secrets (the user guide explains creating a YubiKey backup).
CU03	CC01 Host computer and operating system	**Use a computer you trust** 2d 2e 2i Run KeePassXC only on a computer that is kept updated and free of malware.

CIRCUMSTANCES POTENTIALLY LEADING TO SIGNIFICANT CYBERSECURITY RISK (CR)

ID	Title and Description (reasonably foreseeable misuse or circumstance leading to risk)	Violated Condition of Use (CU)	Potential risk
CR01	**Weak master password** A short or reused master password without another factor.	CU01 Strong master password	Anyone who obtains the database file can guess the password offline.
CR02	**No backup** The only copy of the database, key file or hardware-key secret is lost.	CU02 Keep backups	All stored credentials become unrecoverable.
CR03	**Compromised computer** Malware runs on the host computer.	CU03 Use a computer you trust	Credentials can be captured while the database is unlocked.

3.3.2 Function FC02 Fill credentials in the browser

FUNCTION (FC)

ID	FC02
Title	Fill credentials in the browser
Description	Browser integration with KeePassXC-Browser, including passkeys.
Reasonably foreseeable use [optional]	None beyond the function description.
Core / ancillary functionality	ancillary functionality

SECURE USE DIAGRAM [OPTIONAL]

CONDITIONS OF USE (CU)

ID	Affects (component CC / person CP / zone CZ)	Title & Description
CU04	CC03 Web browser with KeePassXC-Browser	**Official extension only** 2d 2j Install KeePassXC-Browser only from the official browser stores and connect only your own browsers.

CIRCUMSTANCES POTENTIALLY LEADING TO SIGNIFICANT CYBERSECURITY RISK (CR)

ID	Title and Description (reasonably foreseeable misuse or circumstance leading to risk)	Violated Condition of Use (CU)	Potential risk
CR04	**Unofficial browser extension** An extension from another source is connected.	CU04 Official extension only	Credentials are handed to an attacker-controlled extension.

3.3.3 Function FC03 Auto-Type into other applications

FUNCTION (FC)

ID	FC03
Title	Auto-Type into other applications
Description	Type the username and password into the previously selected window.
Reasonably foreseeable use [optional]	Auto-Type into the wrong window.
Core / ancillary functionality	ancillary functionality

SECURE USE DIAGRAM [OPTIONAL]

CONDITIONS OF USE (CU)

ID	Affects (component CC / person CP / zone CZ)	Title & Description
CU05	CP01 User	**Check the target window** 2e Before Auto-Type, make sure the intended window has focus.

CIRCUMSTANCES POTENTIALLY LEADING TO SIGNIFICANT CYBERSECURITY RISK (CR)

ID	Title and Description (reasonably foreseeable misuse or circumstance leading to risk)	Violated Condition of Use (CU)	Potential risk
CR05	**Auto-Type into the wrong window** The focused window is not the intended one.	CU05 Check the target window	The password is typed into a chat, a document or a hostile page.

3.3.4 Function FC04 Unlock the database

FUNCTION (FC)

ID	FC04
Title	Unlock the database
Description	Unlock with the master password and optional key file or hardware key, or with Quick Unlock (biometrics).
Reasonably foreseeable use [optional]	Quick Unlock on a computer account other people use.
Core / ancillary functionality	core functionality

SECURE USE DIAGRAM [OPTIONAL]

CONDITIONS OF USE (CU)

ID	Affects (component CC / person CP / zone CZ)	Title & Description
CU01	CP01 User	**Strong master password** 2d Use a strong master password; add a key file or hardware key for more protection.
CU06	CZ01 User's computer	**Quick Unlock only on a personal account** 2d Disable Quick Unlock if other people can use the same computer account or biometrics.

CIRCUMSTANCES POTENTIALLY LEADING TO SIGNIFICANT CYBERSECURITY RISK (CR)

ID	Title and Description (reasonably foreseeable misuse or circumstance leading to risk)	Violated Condition of Use (CU)	Potential risk
CR01	**Weak master password** A short or reused master password without another factor.	CU01 Strong master password	Anyone who obtains the database file can guess the password offline.
CR06	**Quick Unlock on a shared account** Quick Unlock stays enabled on a computer account others use.	CU06 Quick Unlock only on a personal account	Another person can unlock the database.

3.3.5 Function FC05 Share and sync databases

FUNCTION (FC)

ID	FC05
Title	Share and sync databases
Description	KeeShare shared groups and remote database synchronisation.
Reasonably foreseeable use [optional]	None beyond the function description.
Core / ancillary functionality	ancillary functionality

SECURE USE DIAGRAM [OPTIONAL]

CONDITIONS OF USE (CU)

ID	Affects (component CC / person CP / zone CZ)	Title & Description

CU02	CC02 Database storage location	**Keep backups** 2h Back up the database, key files and hardware-key secrets (the user guide explains creating a YubiKey backup).
CU07	CZ02 Storage and sync services	**Trusted storage and sharing** 2e 2f Store or sync the database only in locations you control or trust, and share groups only with intended people.

CIRCUMSTANCES POTENTIALLY LEADING TO SIGNIFICANT CYBERSECURITY RISK (CR)

ID	Title and Description (reasonably foreseeable misuse or circumstance leading to risk)	Violated Condition of Use (CU)	Potential risk
CR02	**No backup** The only copy of the database, key file or hardware-key secret is lost.	CU02 Keep backups	All stored credentials become unrecoverable.
CR07	**Untrusted storage or sharing** The database is kept or shared in a location others control.	CU07 Trusted storage and sharing	The encrypted file is exposed to offline attack or tampering.

3.4 Secure installation of security updates

Install new releases from the channel used for installation. Flatpak (recommended on Linux) and store channels can update automatically; website downloads are replaced with the new signed package. Verify signatures as described at keepassxc.org/verifying-signatures.

3.4.1 Function FC06 Install security updates

FUNCTION (FC)

ID	FC06
Title	Install security updates
Description	Install the newest signed release from the channel used for installation.
Core / ancillary functionality	ancillary functionality

SECURE USE DIAGRAM [OPTIONAL]

CONDITIONS OF USE (CU)

ID	Affects (component CC / person CP / zone CZ)	Title & Description

CU08	CC05 Distribution channels	**Official, verified downloads** 2c 2f Install from keepassxc.org or an official channel. On Windows, check that the verified publisher is DroidMonkey Apps, LLC; for other sources, verify the PGP signature.

CIRCUMSTANCES POTENTIALLY LEADING TO SIGNIFICANT CYBERSECURITY RISK (CR)

ID	Title and Description (reasonably foreseeable misuse or circumstance leading to risk)	Violated Condition of Use (CU)	Potential risk
CR08	**Tampered installer** KeePassXC is installed from an unofficial source without verification.	CU08 Official, verified downloads	A modified program can steal every credential.

3.4.2 Disabling of automatic security updates

No in-app update mechanism was found in the documentation read; automatic updating depends on the distribution channel.

Please note that CRA conformity is only assured if the necessary security updates have been installed.

3.5 Secure decommissioning and data removal

Before the product is decommissioned:

- Delete the database files, key files and backups from every location they were stored.
- Remove the browser extension, then uninstall KeePassXC.

3.6 Integration guidance for system integrators

Guide to relevant information for system integrators:

Information	Link
Product components and interfaces including used protocols and ports	Chapter 2.1 Product (P)
Product security properties including references to CRA Annex I requirements	Chapter 2.2 Security Properties (SP)
Typical product context including instructions on integration of the product into this context	Chapter 2.3 Context (C)
Product functions including reasonably foreseeable use	Chapter 3.3 Secure use: Conditions of Use (CU) and Circumstances leading to Risk (CR) per product Function (FC)
Intended purpose and reasonably foreseeable use	Chapter 3.1 Intended Purpose and reasonably foreseeable use (IPRFU)

Required security measures (conditions of use) to comply with Annex I requirements when using / integrating the product conditions of use for all product functions and lifecycle phases	Chapter 3 How to use the product securely Chapter 5 Essential requirements reference [optional]
Circumstances leading to risk Note: This is not a full cybersecurity risk assessment. It is recommended to include the full cybersecurity risk assessments for this product in the cybersecurity risk assessment for the integrated product. The full risk assessment is shared upon request using the contact details provided in chapter 4.	Chapter 3.3 Secure use: Conditions of Use (CU) and Circumstances leading to Risk (CR) per product Function (FC)
Applied harmonized standards as part of EU Declaration of Conformity	Chapter 4.3 EU Declaration of Conformity
Software Bill of Materials (SBOM)	Chapter 4.4 Software Bill of Materials (SBOM) [optional]
Vulnerability handling and advisories	Chapter 4.2.3 Access to security advisories, Chapter 5 Essential requirements reference [optional] (Annex I, Part 2)
Reporting vulnerabilities	Chapter 4.2.1 Reporting vulnerabilities to the manufacturer

4 Contact and links

4.1 Manufacturer information

Manufacturer	KeePassXC Team (volunteer project); Windows binaries published by DroidMonkey Apps, LLC. CRA role allocation is for the working group.
Postal address	NOT FOUND in the public documentation read on 8 November 2026.
E-Mail address	team@keepassxc.org
Website	keepassxc.org

4.2 Vulnerabilities and security updates

4.2.1 Reporting vulnerabilities to the manufacturer

Point of contact	GitHub Security Advisory on keepassxreboot/keepassxc, or team@keepassxc.org (encrypt if possible)

Coordinated Vulnerability Disclosure Policy	github.com/keepassxreboot/keepassxc/blob/develop/SECURITY.md

4.2.2 Access to security updates

Access to security updates	keepassxc.org/download
End of support period	NOT FOUND: no support period is published.

4.2.3 Access to security advisories

Access to security advisories	NOT FOUND in the public documentation read on 8 November 2026.

4.3 EU Declaration of Conformity

EU Declaration of Conformity	NOT FOUND: no EU Declaration of Conformity located on 8 November 2026.

4.4 Software Bill of Materials (SBOM) [optional]

Access to SBOM	NOT FOUND in the public documentation read on 8 November 2026.
SBOM formats	NOT FOUND

5 CRA essential requirements reference [optional]

5.1 CRA Annex I, Part I

> Generated crosswalk: each essential requirement lists the Security Properties (SPxx, manufacturer) and Conditions of Use (CUxx, user) that satisfy it, from the Annex I references you attached.

Requirement	CRA Annex I Part I reference	**Security Properties (SPxx) and Conditions of Use (CUxx)** Security Properties are security requirements implemented in the product under responsibility of the manufacturer. Conditions of Use are security requirements outside the product boundary under responsibility of the user.
Secure by default configuration	`(2b)`	Browser integration, Secret Service, SSH agent and network features are off until the user enables them. Quick Unlock (Windows Hello, Touch ID) is ON by default on Windows and macOS and can be disabled under Application Settings > Security.
Secure update mechanism	`(2c)`	See chapter 3.4 Secure installation of security updates. **SP06**: Signed releases **CU08**: Official, verified downloads

Protection from unauthorized access	`(2d)`	**SP02**: Key derivation against guessing **SP03**: Additional unlock factors **CU01**: Strong master password **CU03**: Use a computer you trust **CU04**: Official extension only **CU06**: Quick Unlock only on a personal account
Confidentiality protection	`(2e)`	**SP01**: Database encryption **SP02**: Key derivation against guessing **SP04**: Protected attributes **CU03**: Use a computer you trust **CU05**: Check the target window **CU07**: Trusted storage and sharing
Integrity protection	`(2f)`	**SP01**: Database encryption **SP06**: Signed releases **CU07**: Trusted storage and sharing **CU08**: Official, verified downloads
Data minimisation	`(2g)`	The product only processes the following data: Credentials, notes and attachments the user stores Favicons, only if the user enables downloading them
Availability protection	`(2h)`	**CU02**: Keep backups
Minimisation of negative impact on other services	`(2i)`	**CU03**: Use a computer you trust
Attack surface limitation	`(2j)`	**SP05**: No network access by default **CU04**: Official extension only
Impact reduction	`(2k)`	*SPxx: / CUxx:*
Recording and monitoring	`(2l)`	*SPxx: / CUxx:*
Secure data removal / transfer	`(2m)`	See chapter 3.5 Secure decommissioning and data removal

5.2 CRA Annex I, Part II

Requirement	CRA Annex I Part II reference	Information
Vulnerability	`(1)`	This product is regularly tested for vulnerabilities by the manufacturer.

identification		
Vulnerability documentation / SBOM	(1)	NOT FOUND in the public documentation read on 8 November 2026.
Vulnerability remediation	(2)	Security updates for this product are provided as described in chapter 3.4 Secure installation of security updates and chapter 4.2.2 Access to security updates.
Regular tests	(3)	Independent reviews: ANSSI Security Visa ANSSI-CSPN-2025/16 (17 November 2025, valid to 17 November 2028, version 2.7.9 on Windows 10) and an application security review by Zaur Molotnikov (19 January 2023, version 2.7.4). Reports are published at keepassxc.org/audits.
Public vulnerability disclosure	(4)	NOT FOUND in the public documentation read on 8 November 2026.
Coordinated vulnerability disclosure	(5)	SECURITY.md: report privately through a GitHub Security Advisory, private Matrix messages to named team members, or email. No public channels for first reports. Reporters should not go to a CVE Numbering Authority before the team confirms, unless the team has not responded within 30 days.
Vulnerability contact	(6)	team@keepassxc.org (encryption recommended)
Secure update distribution	(7)	Packages are signed and published with SHA-256 digests; see chapter 3.4.
Security update dissemination	(8)	See chapter 3.4 Secure installation of security updates.